

1.4 Oft-Used Tools

Throughout this book, you'll be using a good number of Photoshop's arsenal of tools; what follows is a list of these often used (and much abused) tools, and a few tips to make working with them second nature—we don't want to handle our tools clumsily while unleashing our creativity, do we? More advanced work with these tools will follow later, but here's what will get you started.

1.4.1 The Zoom Tool

Shortcut: [Z]

It's quite obvious that you're going to use this tool to zoom in and out of the image. To zoom in, just click on the image, and hold down [Alt] and click to zoom out.

1.4.2 Brushes and Brush-Based Tools

Nearly all your work with Photoshop is going to involve at least one brush-based tool, be it the Paintbrush, Pencil, Eraser or the Stamp tool. Here's how to make working with them a breeze:

For All Brush-Based Tools:

- Right-click on the image to bring up a list of brush presets
- Use “[” and “]” to decrease and increase the brush size respectively
- Use “{” and “}” to decrease and increase the brush edge's hardness respectively
- Use [D] to revert to the default colours—black as foreground and white as background
- Use [X] to switch the foreground and background colours



The Brush Tool

Shortcut: [B]; [Shift] + [B] to cycle through other tools in the group

Grouped with: Pencil Tool , Colour Replacement Tool 

The Brush tool supports soft edges and is ideal for painting. You can also convert it into an airbrush by clicking on the air-